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Culture (OWC): [Rwandans \(FO57\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Central Africa

Field Date: 1949....1957

Coverage Date: 1907-1961

Place Coverage: Rwanda

Section Title(S): (B) The Kin Of Ego's Wife

<i>Role</i>	<i>Term of address</i>	<i>Term of reference</i>	601 Kinship Terminology
WiFaBrSo	Name	Muramuwacu	
WiMoSiSo	Name	Muramuwacu	
WiFaSiSo	Name	Muramuwacu	
WiFaSiDa	Name	Muramuwacu	
WiMoBrSo	Name	Muramuwacu	
WiMoBrDa	Name	Muramuwacu	
Female speaking			
HuBr	Name	Mugabowacu	601 Kinship Terminology
HuSi	Name	Muramukaziwanjye	
HuFaBrSo	Name	Mugabowacu	
HuMoSiSo	Name	Mugabowacu	
HuFaSiSo	Name	Mugabowacu	
HuFaSiDa	Name	Mukebawanjye (my rival)	
HuMoBrSo	Name	Mugabowacu	
HuMoBrDa	Name	Mukebawanjye	
HuMoSiDa	Name	Muramukaziwanjye	
HuFaBrDa	Name	Muramukaziwanjye	
HuWi	Name	Mukebawanjye	
HuBrWi	Name	Mukebawacu (our rival)	
HuFaBrSoWi	Name	Mukebawacu (our rival)	
HuMoSiSoWi	Name	Mukebawacu (our rival)	

As has just been mentioned in connexion with the SoWi and the DaHu roles, Ego and his wife were expected to behave respectfully, with restraint as well as with affection towards their parents-in-law. This was reflected in the terminology. WiFa, WiMo, HuFa, HuMo were addressed by the term used for the grandparents. We know that Ego's conduct towards his grandparents was extremely familiar. He had to use the same term for in-laws and was not allowed to pronounce their name. As the preceding nomenclature indicates, the use of the same term of address was extended to all in-laws of the generation above Ego's one. There was again no distinction between the

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Kinship Terminology606
Parents-In-Law And
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grandparents and great-grandparents who were patrilineal ascendants of the spouse and those who were only in the maternal line.

Ego's conduct towards his wife's relatives of the same generation depended mainly on the privileged sex partnership. The determination of those who could be partners was conditioned by the simple principle which assimilates a person to his siblings and parallel cousins. According to this, Ego could have sex relations with those who were assimilated to his wife: her sisters and her parallel cousins. The same applied to a female Ego: her privileged partners are thus her husband's brothers and parallel cousins.

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We have indicated what was meant by a sexual privileged  57 partnership among cross-cousins and that this was only one aspect of wider behaviour patterns of familiarity and joking. The relations between Ego and certain of his affines should be understood in the same sense.

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Kin Relationships

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Siblings-In-Law

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